

- Q7. (a) Briefly describe the factors responsible for decline in marriage in the world and give anthropological interpretations of live in relationships. (20 marks)

Marriage is defined by K. Gough as "the union of a woman with one or more individuals such that offsprings are not denied rights available to other members of society."

'This definition while exceptional, has inclusiveness based on her study of Nogans & Neurs

Factors responsible for decline

- ① Modernisation : Idea of 'single' woman offering more freedom
- ② Industrialisation → woman does not need 'mate' to protect during/after child birth.
⇒ Maternity Benefits Act : 26 wks paid leave
- ③ Feminism : Rise of radical feminism that posits very institution of marriage as patriarchal.

④ Education : (IP Desai) case study
possibly correlates decline in marriage
↑ age with higher educational
qualification

⑤ Social disabilities : (Domestic Violence
against women)

⑥ Law as deterrent : No provision
against marital rape in Bharatya
Nyaya Samhita

⑦ Newer forms of companionship offering
greater freedom

① Live in relationships

② Contractual marriages

③ Sexual freedom - one night stand

④ Openness towards sex as a biological
need

⑤ Ability to adopt children
without married partner

⑧ Medical revolution : IVF technology
→ man's role redundant

In Murdock's conceptualisation

- ① Economic cooperation : Not-required service industry → high income
- ② Sexual privileges : no longer monopolised
- ③ Reproductive need : solved by technology
- ④ Socialisation of child : done through dedicated institutions / tech solution → 'nanny care' iPad Baby

Since the 4 principles were made redundant the idea of marriage itself is on featherhooks.

Anthropology interpretation of live-in

- ① Diffusionism : migrated theory from western world (French predisposition)
- ② Culture lag theory (Ogburn)

non-material culture finally catching up with material culture after lag

- (eg) Internet revolⁿ → pornography access
↓
relⁿ as tool without responsibilities

② Neo-evolutionist theory
 From (primitive promiscuity) (group marriage) etc returning to period of promiscuity (Schliess)
 ↳ curvilinear growth curve

④ Cultural relativism construct :
 Accept it as culture change and not judge it through our lens
 ↳ tolerance as principle

⑤. Structural functional perspective
Status (Boyfriend) & Role (Husband)
 Continue to be played therefore not upsetting the structure of society (marital institution)

⑥ Post modernist world view may also be employed to reject marriage as a construct designed to control by the elites.

Hence Anthropology provides a lens to understand world.